
The 42 Virtues

from

The Paradise of the Soul

by St. Albert the Great

*"I praise you because I am fearfully and wonderfully made;
your works are wonderful, I know that full well."*

— Psalm 139:14

My Holy Crescendo

fearfully & wonderfully made

These forty-two virtues, drawn from St. Albert the Great's "The Paradise of the Soul," form a comprehensive guide for the spiritual life. Each virtue represents a facet of holiness that, when cultivated, draws the soul closer to God and transforms us into the image of Christ.

1. Love of God and Neighbour

The foundation of all Christian life, whereby we love God above all things and our neighbor as ourselves, seeking the eternal good of souls.

2. Humility

True humility fears receiving glory and contemns it when given, always preferring to be unknown rather than celebrated.

3. Obedience

The virtue by which we submit our will to God and His representatives, dying to self-will and embracing divine providence.

4. Patience

The strength to bear adversity, tribulation, and injury with tranquility of spirit, knowing that all comes from God's hand.

5. Poverty

Voluntary poverty of spirit that liberates the soul from attachment to created things, making room for God alone.

6. Chastity

The angelic virtue that keeps the soul pure and undivided, directing all love toward God and spiritual goods.

7. Abstinence

Temperance in food and drink that keeps the body subject to the spirit and maintains clarity of mind for divine contemplation.

8. Prudence

The mother of virtues that guides right judgment, enabling us to choose fitting means to achieve good ends and avoid evil.

9. Fortitude

Spiritual strength that enables the soul to undertake and endure difficult tasks for God without yielding to fear or adversity.

10. Justice

The virtue that renders to God and neighbor what is due, maintaining right order in all relationships and obligations.

11. Temperance

The guardian of all virtues that moderates our inclinations and pleasures, keeping us from excess in temporal goods.

12. Compassion

The virtue of suffering with others, moved by their misery to alleviate their distress through works of mercy.

13. Peace

The tranquility of order that arises from union with God, bringing serenity to the soul and harmony to relationships.

14. Mercy

The virtue by which we are moved with pity for another's distress and seek to relieve it, imitating God's infinite mercy.

15. Concord

Unity of hearts and minds that binds people together in mutual goodwill, reflecting the unity of the Blessed Trinity.

16. Constancy

Firmness of spirit that maintains virtue in the face of changing circumstances and ongoing challenges.

17. Liberality

Proper use of material goods, giving freely without attachment while avoiding both miserliness and prodigality.

18. Truth

The virtue of conforming one's words and deeds to reality, manifesting oneself truthfully to others.

19. Meekness

Gentleness of spirit that moderates anger and maintains tranquility in the face of injury, following Christ's example.

20. Faith

The theological virtue by which we believe in God and all He has revealed, trusting completely in His word.

21. Hope

The theological virtue by which we desire and confidently expect eternal life and the grace needed to attain it.

22. Fear of the Lord

Filial fear that reverences God's greatness and dreads offending Him, the beginning of wisdom and foundation of devotion.

23. Joy

The spiritual gladness that arises from union with God and the contemplation of divine goodness, even amid trials.

24. Sadness for Sin

Holy sorrow for sin that arises from love of God, grieving that we have offended infinite goodness and wounded others.

25. Gratitude

The virtue of recognizing benefits received and making due acknowledgment and return for them.

26. Zeal of Souls

Ardent desire for the salvation of souls, moved by charity to seek the eternal good of all people.

27. Liberty

Spiritual freedom that comes from detachment, liberating the soul from bondage to sin and created things.

28. Religion

The virtue that disposes us to give God the worship and honor proper to Him, expressed through prayer, sacrifice, and sacred observance.

29. Maturity

Spiritual adulthood that transcends beginners' ways, marked by wisdom, stability, and depth in the spiritual life.

30. Simplicity

The virtue of being single in intention and transparent in action, without guile or divided heart.

31. Silence

The virtue that guards the tongue and creates space for contemplation, speaking only what is necessary and good.

32. Solitude

The grace of withdrawing from external distractions to commune with God in the hidden sanctuary of the heart.

33. Contemplation

The loving gaze upon divine truth, resting in God's presence and perceiving spiritual realities with the eyes of the soul.

34. Discretion

The virtue of right judgment that enables one to distinguish between good and evil, appropriate and inappropriate.

35. Congratulation

The virtue of rejoicing with those who rejoice, sharing in the happiness of others without envy or resentment.

36. Confidence

Filial trust in God's goodness and providence, approaching Him with the confidence of beloved children.

37. Contempt of the World

Holy indifference to worldly honors and goods, valuing eternal treasures above temporal vanities.

38. Mortification

The practice of dying to self through voluntary self-denial, subduing the flesh to liberate the spirit.

39. Contrition

Perfect sorrow for sin arising from love of God, grieving that one has offended the Supreme Good.

40. Confession

The virtue of openly acknowledging one's sins and faults before God, leading to healing and restoration.

41. Penance

The virtue of making satisfaction for sins through prayer, fasting, almsgiving, and willingly accepted suffering.

42. Perseverance

Steadfast continuance in good, remaining constant in virtue despite trials, temptations, and the passage of time.